



DIGITAL MARKETING • TERM 4

The Pokémon Company

GROUP 21

Pokémon Trading Cards in India

Media mix, segmentation, personas and creative for the Indian market





OWNED MEDIA

Owned media: channels Pokémon controls

200M+

TCG Pocket downloads by May 2026, on an owned app

Brand-run channels: Pokémon controls the message and builds a direct audience.

TRADITIONAL

TV, physical, live

Anime & films (brand content)

1997 Japan • 1998 US

Used for: Long-form storytelling builds attachment to characters, which then lifts game, card and merchandise sales.

TCG cards & packaging

1996 • 30th sets 2026

Used for: The product doubles as media. 2026 anniversary sets (Pokémon Day Collection, First Partner cards) carry the 30th campaign into stores.

Live events & championships

2004 → Aug 2026

Used for: Play! Pokémon and the World Championships keep core fans engaged; 2026 added the first PokémonXP fan event in San Francisco.

DIGITAL

apps, streaming, social

Pokémon Presents livestreams

Annual • latest Feb 2026

Used for: Direct-to-fan announcements. The Feb 2026 show, streamed on YouTube, Twitch, TikTok and Instagram, revealed Gen 10 (Winds and Waves).

Pokémon TCG Pocket app

Oct 2024 → 2026

Used for: A brand-published app is a permanent direct channel to players: 6M+ pre-registrations, 10M downloads in 48 hours, 200M by May 2026.

pokemon.com/30 hub & shop

Feb 2026 → yearlong

Used for: Hub for “What’s Your Favorite?”, a 30th logo for every Pokémon, and limited-run anniversary merch on Pokémon Center online.



EARNED MEDIA

Earned media: attention Pokémon earns

\$16.5M

Pikachu Illustrator auction, Feb 2026, covered by CNN and others

Coverage and fan content created by others: credible and scalable, but not controllable.

TRADITIONAL

TV, physical, live

Playground word of mouth

1998–1999

Used for: Card-swapping at school spread the craze peer to peer; Burger King outlets ran out of toys at the 1999 peak.

News & broadcast coverage

Jul 2016

Used for: Pokémon GO's launch was covered by outlets such as the New York Times, Time, The Guardian, CNN and BBC, giving huge free awareness.

Negative coverage (risk)

Dec 1999

Used for: Earned media can turn negative: the recall of Poké Ball containers from the Burger King promotion made news the brand could not steer.

DIGITAL

apps, streaming, social

Pokémon GO social virality

Jul–Sep 2016

Used for: Fan photos and posts of crowds at PokéStops drove FOMO; the game passed 500M downloads by Sep 2016, largely on organic buzz.

Creator & collector hype

Jul 2021 → Feb 2026

Used for: Logan Paul's Pikachu Illustrator card: a \$5.275M purchase (Guinness record), then a \$16.5M auction run on a YouTube livestream.

Streaming & fan community buzz

Oct 2024 → 2026

Used for: TCG Pocket became one of 2024's most-watched games on streaming platforms (~14M hours), a free reach boost around its launch.



PAID MEDIA

Paid media: reach Pokémon buys

\$8–10M

typical cost of a 30-sec Super Bowl LX slot
(Pokémon's spend is undisclosed)

Placements and partnerships bought for reach, timed to launches and anniversaries.

TRADITIONAL

TV, physical, live

DIGITAL

apps, streaming, social

Super Bowl TV commercial

8 Feb 2026

Used for: Launched the yearlong 30th campaign (“What’s Your Favorite?”, with Lady Gaga, Trevor Noah, Jisoo). Slots run ~\$8–10M per 30 sec.

P25 Music with Universal

Jan–Oct 2021

Used for: Celebrity-led 25th campaign: Post Malone's virtual concert (YouTube, Twitch), Katy Perry and J Balvin songs, and an album on 15 Oct 2021.

Macy's parade Pikachu balloon

2001 • redesigned 2014

Used for: Sponsored parade presence that promotes the latest games, TV seasons and cards to a mass family audience each Thanksgiving.

Partner co-marketing (LEGO)

27 Feb 2026

Used for: First-ever LEGO Pokémon sets launched on Pokémon Day, extending 30th-anniversary reach through the partner's own audience.

Retail & fast-food co-promotion

Nov–Dec 1999

Used for: Burger King kids' meals bundled Poké Ball toys and trading cards with the first movie's US release (Nov 1999); 25M+ toys were planned.

App-install & social ads*

Oct 2024 (TCG Pocket)

Used for: *Assumption: ad spend is not public. Standard for mobile launches; TCG Pocket built 6M+ pre-registrations before its Oct 2024 release.



SEGMENTATION • DEMOGRAPHIC

Demographic: who buys the cards

3

core age bands driving demand in India

Age, income and life stage split India's Pokémon TCG buyers into three very different wallets.

Children, 8–14

Age / life stage

Entry buyers reached through the anime, Pokémon GO and TCG Pocket; spend is small and parent-approved, usually on single booster or blister packs.

Teens & young adults, 15–24

Age / occupation

Students and early-career players who build decks for local tournaments; price-sensitive but willing to spend on playable singles.

Millennials, 25–35

Age / income

Working professionals with disposable income who grew up watching the anime on Indian TV in the early 2000s; buy Elite Trainer Boxes and graded singles as collectors.

Demographic split shows income, not age alone, decides basket size, we assess the 25–35 band as the highest spender per order.

Sources: TCGVault, PokéTCG, TCG Republic (2026 India retail listings); Pokémon 30th-anniversary press coverage.



SEGMENTATION • GEOGRAPHIC

Geographic: where the market actually exists

With no official Pokémon Company distributor, India's market is a handful of metro pockets, not a national footprint.

6

metro / Tier-1 cities host the importer stores and player communities

Metro hubs (Mumbai, Bengaluru, Delhi-NCR)

City type

Home to India's specialty importer stores (TCG Republic, Beyond Gaming) and organised communities like the India TCG Association in Bengaluru.

Tier-1 cities (Pune, Hyderabad, Chennai)

Region

Growing hobby-store and online-order base, but fewer in-person meetups or tournaments than the top three metros.

Tier-2/3 towns & rural India

Urban / rural

Minimal presence: no official distribution and few local stores, so buyers here depend on online orders and courier shipping.

Geographic segmentation says the real go-to-market is city-by-city, built around the same six cities that already have importer stores and player communities.

Sources: TCG Republic (Mumbai); India TCG Association / Limitless TCG (Bengaluru); TCGVault India buying guide.



SEGMENTATION • PSYCHOGRAPHIC

Psychographic: what they value

Lifestyle and personality separate nostalgia-driven collectors from competitive strategists and speculative investors.

30th

anniversary (2026) is actively fuelling the nostalgia segment

Nostalgic pop-culture fans

Lifestyle

Adults reconnecting with a childhood franchise; values are sentimental — owning the same cards or characters they grew up watching.

Detail-oriented collectors

Personality traits

Curators who care about condition, grading (PSA/CGC) and provenance; risk-averse about counterfeits, given India's import-only supply.

Competitive strategists & investors

Values & beliefs

Players who value skill and deckbuilding, and investors who treat sealed product and rare singles as an appreciating, tradeable asset.

The nostalgia and collector mindsets are the strongest psychographic fit for India's premium-priced, import-driven retail model.

Sources: TCGVault India collector guide; Yahoo Finance / TCGplayer coverage of TCG collector demand (2026).



Behavioural: how they use and buy

4

buying behaviours identified in the Indian market

Usage rate and purchase motive split buyers into heavy collectors, casual players, gift-buyers and resellers.

Heavy collectors (chase every set)

Usage rate / loyalty

Repeat buyers who pre-order new sets the day they list on Indian importer sites.

Casual players

Usage rate / buying behaviour

Buy to play with friends or family; occasional purchases rather than chasing every set.

Gift buyers (parents and relatives)

Occasion-based

One-time buyers picking up a blister pack or Elite Trainer Box for a birthday or festival.

Resellers / investors

Benefits sought

Buy sealed product specifically to grade and flip; benefit sought is appreciation and margin, not gameplay or display.

Behavioural segmentation shows loyalty (heavy collectors) and benefit sought (resellers) split the market more usefully than age does.



SEGMENTATION • WEBOGRAPHIC

Webographic: where they live online

Community-led

WhatsApp + Discord groups anchor India's trading & tournament infrastructure

India's Pokémon TCG scene runs largely on niche digital spaces, not mainstream marketplaces.

Niche Shopify storefronts

Platforms / online buying

TCGVault, PokéTCG, TCG Republic and Beyond Gaming — specialty importer sites, rather than the large marketplaces, are where buyers find authentic product.

Instagram & YouTube

Content / creators

Unboxing and pull videos, price/authentication guides, and store drop announcements drive discovery and trust.

WhatsApp & Discord communities

Communities

The India TCG Association and similar groups run trades, tournaments and restock alerts, filling the gap left by no official Play! Pokémon network.

Webographic segmentation confirms the India opportunity is community-led: trust and access run through creators and private groups, not open marketplaces.

Sources: India TCG Association (Limitless TCG); TCGVault, PokéTCG storefronts; Disboard Pokémon-TCG Discord listings.



TARGETING

Targeting: who we choose

Three candidate segments scored on seven criteria; nostalgic millennial collectors come out on top.

Criterion	Young collectors (8–14)	Nostalgic collectors (25–35): primary	Competitive players (15–24)
Market size / potential	Large pool of school-age kids, but low spend and parental gatekeeping	Smaller in numbers, but the highest average spend per buyer	Medium; a small but steadily growing base
Growth potential	High: Pokémon GO / TCG Pocket cross-over and anime reruns	High: 30th anniversary (2026) and rising collector / resale culture	Medium-High: tournament scene expanding from a small base
Need / fit	Good for entry-level packs; price-sensitive	Excellent: a core driver of premium-priced collector demand	Good for playable lines; needs affordable singles
Accessibility / digital reach	Reachable only indirectly, through parents	Highly reachable: Instagram / YouTube, comfortable paying online and importing	Reachable via WhatsApp / Discord, but groups are small and city-specific
Competition	High: cheaper unlicensed cards, mobile games, other toys	Moderate: One Piece / Yu-Gi-Oh! collectors, but nostalgia is a strong lock-in	Moderate: Yu-Gi-Oh! has a loyal base; Pokémon's tournament ecosystem is bigger
Profit potential	Lower: small basket sizes	Highest: larger baskets (ETBs, graded cards), lower price sensitivity	Medium: recurring deck-building, lower-margin singles
Strategic fit	Builds the long-term funnel, but poorly served without an official distributor	Strongest fit with India's import-led, niche specialty retail	Supports long-term community and brand health

Primary target: nostalgic millennial collectors (25–35), metro India. Approach: concentrated / niche.

Scores are qualitative assessments from India retail listings and community research, not market-size data. Same matrix as the STP worksheet.



PERSONAS • ALL SEGMENTS

Ten personas across five segments

10

illustrative personas, 2 per segment across 5 segments

Two illustrative personas for each of the five segments in India's Pokémon TCG market.

Young collectors, 8–14	Nostalgic collectors, 25–35	Competitive players, 15–24	Reseller-investors	Parent / gift buyers
Aarav, 11 Pune • Class 6 student Got a blister pack for his birthday; swaps duplicates with classmates at school.	Rohan, 29 Bengaluru • Software engineer Rebuilding his childhood collection; pre-orders anniversary sets and grades his best pulls.	Kabir, 19 Delhi-NCR • Engineering student Plays local tournaments; buys playable singles to tune his deck on a student budget.	Vikram, 27 Hyderabad • Sales executive Buys sealed boxes, sends top pulls for grading and resells through Instagram DMs.	Priya, 38 Pune • Mother of a 10-year-old Buys an Elite Trainer Box for birthdays; asks the store which set suits her child.
Anaya, 13 Mumbai • Class 8 student Plays TCG Pocket; saves festival money for physical cards of her favourite Eevee.	Neha, 32 Mumbai • Brand manager Buys Elite Trainer Boxes to display; rewatches the anime; shares unboxings on Instagram.	Ishaan, 22 Bengaluru • Junior analyst Regular at weekly meet-ups; helps run a city WhatsApp group and trades at events.	Meera, 34 Chennai • Finance professional Treats sealed product and rare singles as an alternative asset; tracks prices weekly.	Sanjay, 41 Delhi-NCR • Business owner Buys packs as a festival gift or reward; unfamiliar with the rules; wants a trusted seller.

Ten personas, two per segment. Rohan (highlighted) is the ideal persona we target, see the next slide for more information.

Illustrative personas built from the segment research (India retail listings, TCG communities); not real individuals.



IDEAL PERSONA • PRIMARY TARGET

Ideal persona: Rohan, the Nostalgic Collector

25–35

age band of the primary target segment

Rohan represents our primary target: nostalgic millennial collectors (25–35) in metro India.



Rohan

The Nostalgic Collector

AGE • LOCATION

29, male • Bengaluru

OCCUPATION • INCOME

Software engineer • ~₹14–18 LPA

LIFE STAGE

Single, lives independently

LIFESTYLE

Anime, gaming and pop-culture conventions;
active on Instagram and YouTube

Goals

Complete the childhood-favourite set; build a display-worthy collection; occasionally profit from rare pulls.

Purchase motivations

Nostalgia tied to the 30th anniversary, rarity and the chase, resale value, and sharing pulls online.

Brand preferences

Trusts TCGVault, PokéTCG and TCG Republic (Mumbai); prefers PSA/CGC-graded cards; follows official Pokémon channels.

Frustrations

High import markups and customs delays; counterfeit risk; no official store network or events nearby.

Digital behaviour

Instagram, YouTube, WhatsApp, Discord; buys via niche Shopify stores and WhatsApp catalogues; vets sellers on Google reviews and Discord.

Why he is the ideal target

Highest spend per buyer, lowest price sensitivity, easy to reach digitally, and re-engaged by the 30th anniversary now.

Positioning: for nostalgic collectors in urban India, Pokémon TCG turns childhood nostalgia into a rewarding, tradeable hobby.

Source: STP + Customer Persona worksheet (Pokémon TCG, India); TCGVault, PokéTCG and TCG Republic listings; India TCG Association.



POSITIONING

Positioning: how we stand apart

Nostalgic, globally trusted and premium, against newer and cheaper alternatives.

Positioning statement

For nostalgic millennial collectors and pop-culture fans in urban India, Pokémon TCG is the authentic, globally iconic collectible card line that turns childhood nostalgia into a rewarding, tradeable hobby because it combines beloved characters, rare hand-illustrated art, and a genuine global secondary market that few other collectibles in India can match.

One-line STP

We target nostalgic pop-culture collectors and competitive young players in urban India, represented by “Rohan, the Nostalgic Collector”, with Pokémon TCG's authentic, globally recognised collectible cards, positioned around trusted, nostalgia-driven collecting and community.

Brand / product	Target customer	Key benefit	Price position	Positioning
Ours: Pokémon TCG	Nostalgic collectors and competitive players, 15–35, metro India	Iconic 30-year IP, rarity / chase appeal, strongest global resale market	Premium (import-driven pricing)	The nostalgic, globally trusted collectible
Competitor 1: One Piece Card Game	Younger anime fans and speculative investors	Fastest-growing TCG; strong recent price appreciation	Premium	The hottest new collectible
Competitor 2: Yu-Gi-Oh!	Dedicated competitive strategy-game players	Deep, skill-based competitive gameplay	Mid-to-premium	The serious player's game
Competitor 3: Unlicensed / local cards	Price-sensitive children and casual buyers	Cheap and widely available (IndiaMART, local stores)	Low (₹90–₹150 per pack)	The affordable local alternative

Perceptual-map axes: price / exclusivity (low to high) vs nostalgia / brand emotional equity (low to high).

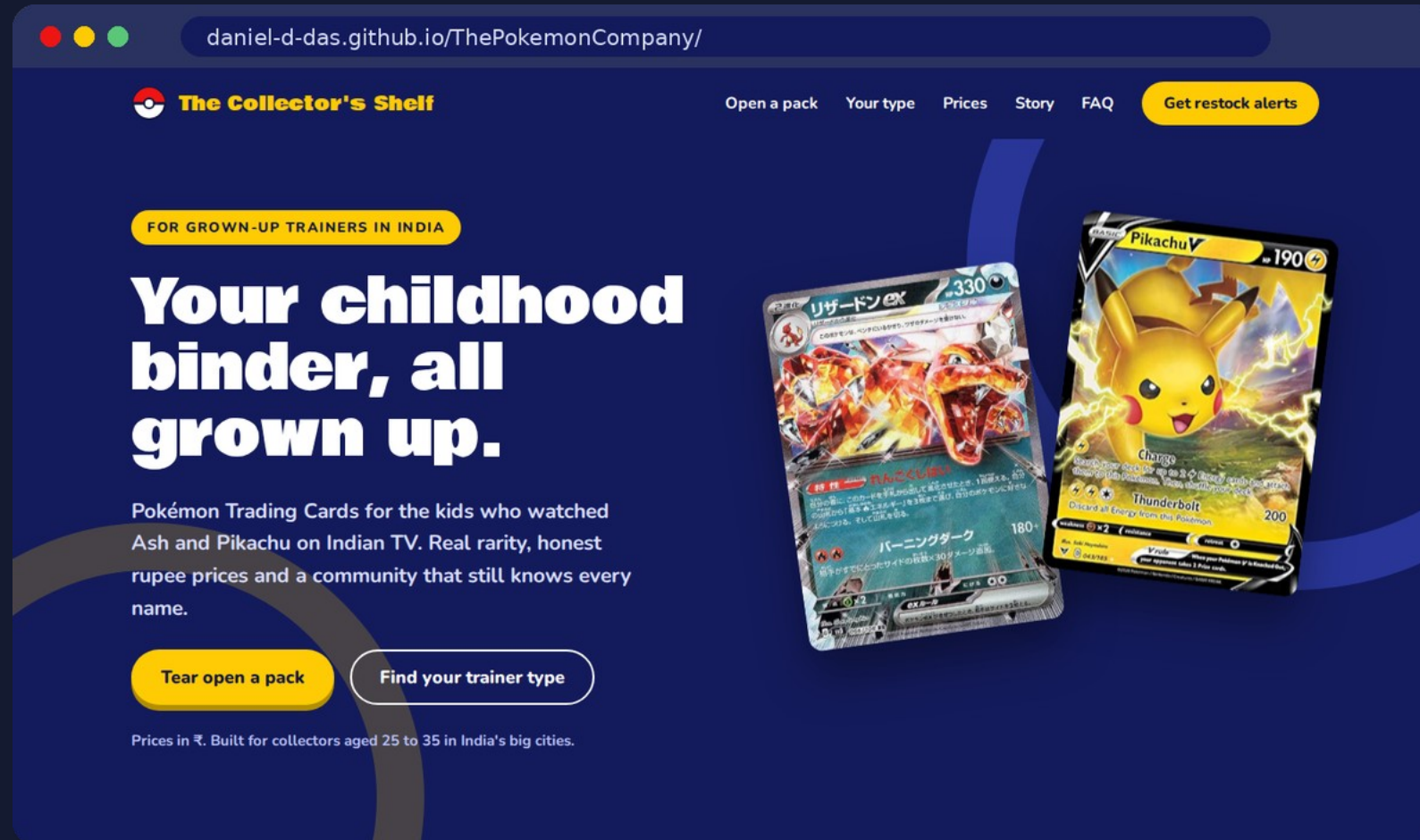
Same statement and competitor table as the STP worksheet. Competitor prices are indicative, from Indian retail listings.



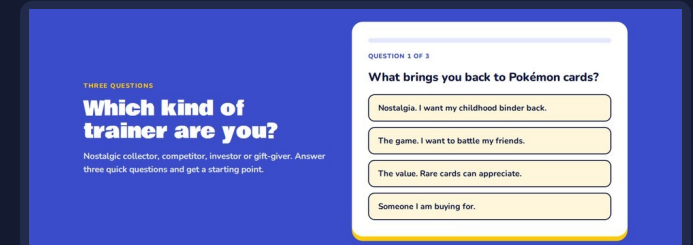
CREATIVE · LANDING PAGE

The landing page

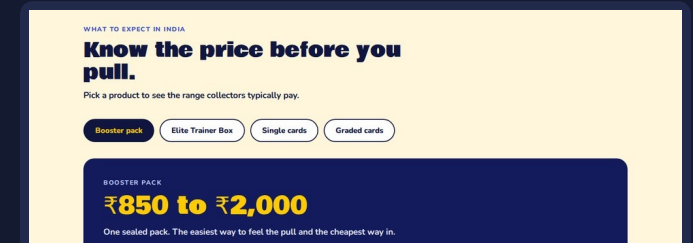
Live at daniel-d-das.github.io/ThePokemonCompany/ with a hero, pack opener, trainer quiz and price guide. Click the page to open it.



Pack opener: 21 cards to find



Trainer-type quiz



Price guide in rupees



CREATIVE • POSTER

The campaign poster

One square visual for social feeds, built around our ideal persona: the nostalgic collector.



The Collector's Shelf

POKÉMON TRADING CARDS · INDIA

FOR INDIA'S ORIGINAL TRAINERS

Your childhood binder, all grown up.

Pick up where you left off. Real rarity, honest rupee prices, and a shelf worth showing off.



★ Real rarity

Holo shine and chase cards. The pull is the point.

🏷️ Honest ₹ pricing

Import costs explained up front. No checkout surprises.

👤 Built for grown-ups

Sleeves, storage and grading tips for people with a job and a shelf.

Open your first pack.



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